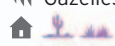
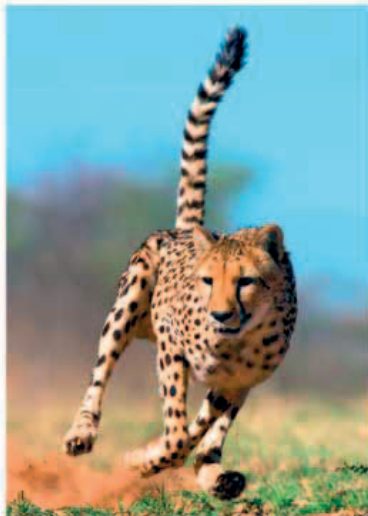




short, rounded ears

- ↔ 4–5 ft (1.2–1.5 m)
- ⚖ 46–160 lb (21–72 kg)
- ⊗ Vulnerable
- 🌿 Gazelles, antelopes
- 🏠 

Africa and
SW. Asia



△ BORN TO RUN

The “greyhound of cats” is the fastest mammal on land. The cheetah can reach speeds of more than 70 mph (115 km/h) in three seconds. An average sprint lasts about 20 seconds.

◁ TEAR LINES

The distinctive black lines on a cheetah’s face may protect its eyes from the sun’s glare and also help it to focus on prey.

Impala

Aepyceros melampus

horns present
only in males

reddish fawn coat



A medium-sized antelope, the impala is distinguished by its black-tipped ears, rump and tail stripes, and black tufts above its rear hoofs. Male impala grow beautiful ridged, lyre-shaped horns that are up to 36 in (90 cm) long. These superbly agile mammals can change direction almost instantly and leap long and high over shrubs, bushes, and even other impala.

Impala rest and graze during the day and night. They eat grass in the wet season and feed on shrubs, bushes, fruit, and acacia pods during drier periods.

Spring and fall ruts

Mating takes place in a twice-yearly “rut,” when males fight each other for access to females. They become noisier than usual, snorting and bellowing to advertise and defend territories. Successful males mate with several females in spring and fall, and the young are born about seven months later.

Outside the mating season, impala divide into smaller herds of bachelor males and larger herds of females and calves. The herd provides protection from predators, such as lions, hyenas, and leopards—an alert impala “barks” a warning that sets the entire herd fleeing.

- ↔ 4–5 ft (1.2–1.5 m)
- ⚖ 88–143 lb (40–65 kg)
- ⊗ Locally common
- 🌿 Grass, leaves, bark
- 🏠 

E. and
S. Africa



▽ LEAPING TO SAFETY

Impala flee from predators into dense vegetation. They can leap as far as 30 ft (9 m) and as high as 8 ft (2.5 m).



Impala **release scent signals** as they **kick and leap**, which are thought to **lay trails** for other **herd members**